squarely before us. Our pharmacist does not wish to editorialize on any subject, cultural, philosophical, or political. He does not wish to report any particularly newsworthy fact, or to make generalized observations even about commercial matters. The "idea" he wishes to communicate is simply this: "I will sell you the X prescription drug at the Y price." Our question, then, is whether this communication is wholly outside the protection of the First Amendment.

V

We begin with several propositions that already are settled or beyond serious dispute. It is clear, for example, that speech does not lose its First Amendment protection because money is spent to project it, as in a paid advertisement of one form or another. *Buckley* v. *Valeo,* 424 U. S. 1, 35–59 (1976); *Pittsburgh Press Co.* v. *Human Relations Comm'n,* 413 U. S., at 384; *New York Times Co.* v. *Sullivan,* 376 U. S., at 266. Speech likewise is protected even though it is carried in a form that is "sold" for profit, *Smith* v. *California,* 361 U. S. 147, 150 (1959) (books); *Joseph Burstyn, Inc.* v. *Wilson,* 343 U. S. 495, 501 (1952) (motion pictures); *Murdock* v. *Pennsylvania,* 319 U. S., at 111 (religious literature), and even though it may involve a solicitation to purchase or otherwise pay or contribute money. *New York Times Co.* v. *Sullivan, supra; NAACP* v. *Button,* 371 U. S. 415, 429 (1963); *Jamison* v. *Texas,* 318 U. S., at 417; *Cantwell* v. *Connecticut,* 310 U. S. 296, 306–307 (1940).

If there is a kind of commercial speech that lacks all First Amendment protection, therefore, it must be distinguished by its content. Yet the speech whose content deprives it of protection cannot simply be speech on a commercial subject. No one would contend that our pharmacist may be prevented from being heard on